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PII Types

PII Types

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PII Types define the kinds of sensitive information DataX should recognise, such as email address, phone number, customer ID, or national ID. Each PII Type includes one or more matching patterns, and every pattern is tied to an Integration System so detection stays relevant to that source.

Overview

Use PII Types when you want to:

- create the categories Data Discovery can assign to columns
- add or refine matching patterns for a specific source system
- choose the Field Data Category used by privacy models
- set the default privacy model group and model used when Data Discovery assigns the type
- reuse the same sensitivity category across multiple discovery runs

Where To Access

Go to **Admin > DataX > PII Types**.

Before You Start

Have the following ready:

- the business name of the sensitive field type you want to track
- the sensitivity level you want to assign
- the Field Data Category that best represents the type
- the default privacy model group and model to use for discovered fields
- the Integration System the pattern belongs to
- the actual keywords or regex-style patterns that identify the field names used in that system

Key Elements

List Page

The list page shows your PII catalog and supports search, sorting, and the standard actions available to your role.

Column	Meaning
PII Type ID	The internal identifier for the type
PII Type Name	The short business name, such as EMAIL or PHONE
PII Level	The sensitivity level: HIGH , MEDIUM , or LOW
Field Data Category	The privacy-model category for the type, such as address, name, or phone number
Default Privacy Model Group	The model group used by default when this PII Type is assigned during discovery
Default Privacy Model	The default model selected from the chosen group and Field Data Category

Typical actions on this page are:

- **Create** a new PII Type
- **Edit** pattern definitions on an existing type
- **Clone** a type and its pattern structure
- **Delete** a type and its related patterns

Form Fields

When you create a new PII Type, complete the header fields and add at least one pattern.

Field	How To Use It
PII Type Name	A short label for the sensitive field category
Description	Optional business description for other admins
PII Level	The overall sensitivity of the category
Field Data Category	The category used to find compatible privacy models
Default Privacy Model Group	The model group to use when Data Discovery assigns this type
Default Privacy Model	The model to apply by default for generated Data Formats
Patterns	One or more matching rules that help Data Discovery recognise this type

The default model list is filtered by the selected Field Data Category and model group. If you change either value, choose a compatible model before saving.

Pattern Groups

Patterns are managed in groups by **Integration System**. Instead of adding one flat row at a time, you first add the system group and then maintain that system's patterns inside its own section.

Each group supports:

- one Integration System per group
- separate sections for **KEYWORD** and **REGEX** patterns
- bulk entry of multiple patterns in one action
- click-to-edit for an existing pattern chip
- delete for a single pattern or the whole system group

NOTE

You cannot create duplicate pattern groups for the same Integration System in the same PII Type.

Each saved pattern still uses the same core fields:

Pattern Field	How To Use It
Match Pattern	The keyword or expression that should match a column or XML field name
Pattern Type	Choose KEYWORD for direct name matching or REGEX for more flexible matching rules
Integration System	The source system this pattern applies to

Pattern Entry Behavior

Inside each Integration System group:

- choose whether you are adding **KEYWORD** or **REGEX** patterns
- enter one pattern or paste multiple patterns together
- use comma, semicolon, or a new line to separate multiple values
- click an existing pattern chip to load it back into the editor for update
- use the delete icon on a chip to remove only that pattern

NOTE

When you edit an existing pattern, the screen accepts one value at a time. Bulk input is for adding new patterns, not changing one saved pattern into many.

Common Tasks

Create A PII Type

To create a PII Type:

1. Click **Create PII Type**.
2. Enter the name, description, level, and Field Data Category.
3. Select the default privacy model group and default privacy model.
4. In the **Patterns** section, select the Integration System and click **Add** to create the first pattern group.
5. Choose the pattern type: **KEYWORD** or **REGEX**.
6. Enter one or more patterns for that group.
7. Repeat for other Integration Systems if needed.
8. Save the record.

Expected outcome:

- each Integration System appears as its own expandable group
- patterns are shown as chips inside **KEYWORD** or **REGEX** sections
- duplicate values for the same pattern type are ignored when you bulk add

Edit An Existing PII Type

When you open an existing PII Type, you can update both the header fields and the pattern list.

Common updates include:

- changing the description, level, or Field Data Category
- changing the default privacy model group or model
- adding a new pattern for the same system
- removing an outdated pattern
- moving a pattern to the correct Integration System
- changing a pattern from `KEYWORD` to `REGEX` or the reverse

To update patterns on an existing PII Type:

1. Open the required PII Type from the list.
2. Update the header fields if the business meaning or default privacy model has changed.
3. Expand the Integration System group you want to maintain.
4. To add patterns, choose the pattern type and paste or type the new values.
5. To edit one pattern, click its chip, change the value, and save.
6. To remove one pattern, use the delete icon on that chip.
7. To remove all patterns for one system, delete the whole Integration System group.

NOTE

Changing the default privacy model affects future discovery assignments. Columns already reviewed in a discovery run keep their saved model group and model unless the user changes the PII Type again in the results screen.

Clone A PII Type

Use **Clone** when a new PII Type is similar to an existing one. The new form opens with the original values and patterns, which you can then adjust before saving.

Delete A PII Type

Deleting a PII Type also removes its saved patterns. Only delete a type when you are sure it is no longer needed for discovery or privacy model assignment.

Tips And Best Practices

- Keep one clear business meaning per PII Type.
- Choose a Field Data Category that matches how the field should be anonymised or masked.
- Keep the default privacy model compatible with the Field Data Category.

- Use separate patterns for different Integration Systems when field naming differs by source.
- Use one group per Integration System and keep each group focused on that system's naming conventions.
- Paste pattern lists in bulk when onboarding a new system, then fine-tune individual chips afterward.
- Start simple with keywords, then use regex only when you need more control.
- Review patterns after a discovery run if expected fields were missed or over-matched.

Related Pages

- [Integration Systems](#)
- [Data Discovery](#)
- [Configurations](#)



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